

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 708

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to commend and congratulate Vincent Ruiz,
National Marbles Tournament winner.

WHEREAS, it is our privilege to recognize those young Tennesseans whose passion, devotion, and skill inspire others and who serve as exceptional ambassadors of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Vincent Ruiz of Nashville, who claimed victory at the 2025 National Marbles Tournament, held in Wildwood, New Jersey; and

WHEREAS, an eighth-grade student, he is only the third player in the tournament's 102-year history to compete and win their very first year; and

WHEREAS, Vincent Ruiz is self-taught in marbles; after becoming interested in learning how to play Ringer marbles, he watched YouTube videos and researched previous champions and game-play rules; and

WHEREAS, he represented Standing Stone in the tournament, where he had gone to play on an actual Ringer court and ended up meeting Coach Brian Cherry; and

WHEREAS, during the national tournament, Vincent played a total of seventy games, losing only two of those (which were split between his own Tennessee teammates) for a record of 68-2; and

WHEREAS, his national victory is a great source of pride for his family, his school, and the people of Nashville and Standing Stone; and

WHEREAS, Vincent Ruiz's initiative, dedication, and drive helped him claim the title of national champion and certainly bode well for his future success; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we honor one of Tennessee's most exceptional young citizens on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commend and congratulate Vincent Ruiz on his victory at the 2025 National Marbles Tournament, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.